

2. Process Description

Reflection

EGR 3350-07

Technical Communications for Engineers and Computer Scientists

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Reflection: Two-Factor Authentication Verification Process

Writing the process description for the two-factor authentication (2FA) verification process was a valuable exercise in structuring technical information for a general audience. Looking back on the assignment, I can identify both strengths in the paper and areas where my writing could have been more effective.

One aspect I am most satisfied with is the logical flow of the five-step sequence. By breaking the authentication process into clearly labeled stages: entry of primary credentials, system validation and code generation, transmission of the verification code, entry and verification of the secondary code, and access authorization, I provided readers with a clear roadmap before they encountered the details of each step. The instructor's comment that it was 'nicely done' confirmed that the overall structure was sound. The flowchart in Figure 1 also reinforced the written explanation effectively, giving readers a visual reference for the sequence.

However, reviewing the instructor's feedback reveals two areas for growth. First, the professor noted that the last two steps in the flowchart, 'User Enters Code' and 'Access Granted or Denied,' could be combined. This points to a broader issue in my writing: I was not always thinking critically about whether each step represented a meaningfully distinct stage in the process or whether I was artificially separating ideas that belong together. In technical writing, unnecessary divisions can create confusion rather than clarity.

Second, the feedback on the 'Entry and Verification of Secondary Code' section flagged imprecise word choice. The word 'either' was struck through and replaced with a more precise term. This reflects a tendency I noticed in my own writing: occasionally choosing words that feel

natural in everyday speech without verifying that they carry precise technical meaning. In a document describing a security process, precision is essential.

Overall, this assignment taught me that even a well-organized technical document benefits from a final critical review at both the structural and sentence level. I came away with a clearer understanding of how to evaluate whether divisions genuinely serve the reader and how to select language that is accurate and accessible. These lessons will shape how I approach all future technical writing.